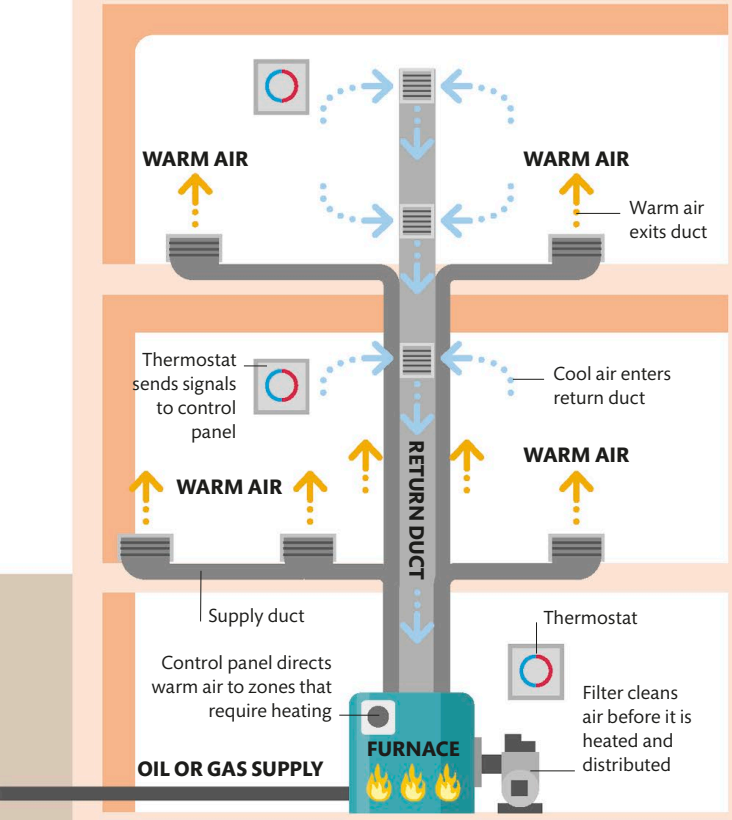
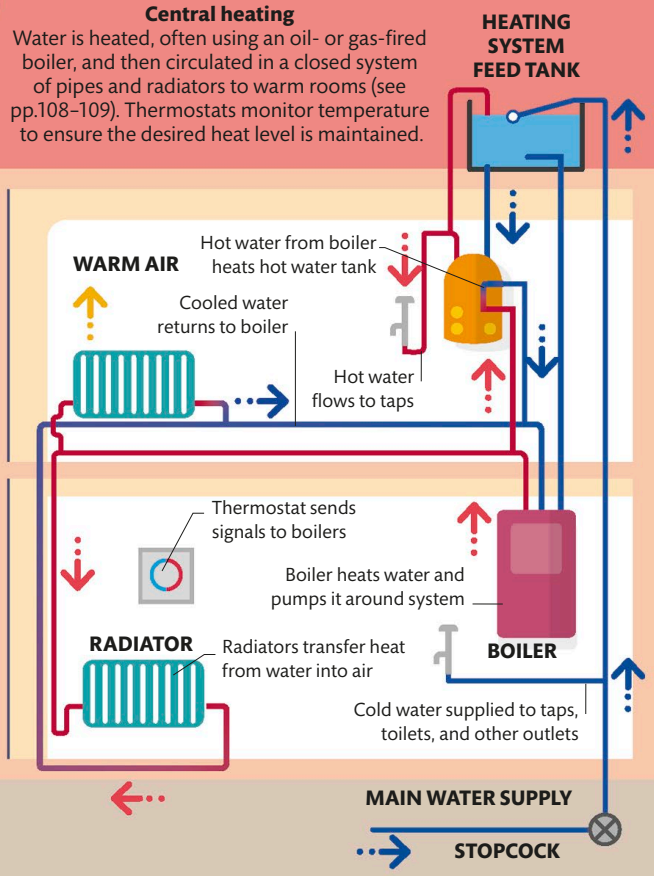
Hot-air heating
In hot-air heating systems, cool air is drawn out of rooms and travels through a return duct to a heating unit. There, it is warmed by a heat exchanger powered by a furnace, typically burning oil or gas. The warm air rises and is channeled around the property through supply ducts.



Central heating
Water is heated, often using an oil- or gas-fired boiler, and then circulated in a closed system of pipes and radiators to warm rooms (see pp.108–109). Thermostats monitor temperature to ensure the desired heat level is maintained.



House systems

Most utilities tend to feature an external or main supply, such as a pipeline carrying natural gas or water, which enters the home and is then distributed around the property. Utilities can usually be shut off or disconnected easily in the event of a problem or if a property is lying empty.

Utilities in the home

Utilities include power, heating, water, and communications services supplied to homes. They are usually provided by external companies, although some properties may have an independent water supply or heating source, such as a wood-burning fire.